FIGHTERBASE

# High-protein performance

## Diet guide

Protein at every meal, carbs timed to training.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

# How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap High-protein performance**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

# What is High-protein performance?

A balanced diet with protein put first. Popular with combat athletes because protein helps muscles repair after hard rounds and keeps you full.

## Where it comes from

High-protein eating grew out of sports nutrition. Protein supplies the building blocks that repair muscle after hard training, and it keeps people fuller between meals.

## The main ideas

1. A protein food at every meal and most snacks.
2. Spread protein across the day (3 to 5 feeds) rather than one huge meal.
3. Keep carbs for fuel and fibre-rich vegetables for health: protein does not replace them.
4. A common sports nutrition range for athletes is about 1.6 to 2.2 g of protein per kg of body weight a day. Your own number should be confirmed by a dietitian.
5. Food first. Shakes and bars are for convenience.

## Who it suits

- People training hard several times a week
- People trying to keep muscle while losing fat
- People who feel hungry on lower-protein diets

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
> - You have kidney disease or any kidney concern (talk to your doctor before raising protein)
> - You have a history of disordered eating
> - You are under 18

TRAINING

# Fuel for training

- Aim for roughly 20 to 40 g of protein in each main meal and one after training.
- Pair protein with carbs after hard sessions so the body can refill energy as well as repair.
- Before training choose something easy to digest: yoghurt and fruit, eggs on toast, or a small chicken and rice meal a couple of hours before.
- In fight camp keep protein steady and let carbs flex with the training load.

> Protein spread across 3 to 5 meals, including one after training. Carbs scaled to how hard the day is.

## Nutrients to keep an eye on

**Fibre**
protein foods contain little
Where: vegetables, fruit, beans, wholegrains, oats

**Carbohydrate**
do not let protein crowd it out
Where: rice, potatoes, oats, fruit

**Fluid**
a higher-protein diet suits plenty of water
Where: water, tea, milk

**Calcium**
if dairy is limited
Where: dairy, tinned fish with bones, fortified alternatives

## Common mistakes

- Eating only protein and skipping carbs, then feeling flat in sparring
- Relying on bars and shakes full of sugar or sweeteners
- Forgetting vegetables and fibre
- Thinking more is always better

EVERYDAY LIFE

# Labels, eating out and swaps

## Reading labels

- Protein per serving (not per 100 g) when comparing bars and shakes
- Added sugar and sugar alcohols in protein bars
- Whey, casein, milk protein: dairy. Soy, pea: plant

## Eating out

- Ask for a double portion of the grilled protein.
- Choose rice or potatoes plus a vegetable side.
- Skip creamy sauces and breaded options.
- Add a side salad.

## Easy swaps

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Cereal and milk | → | Greek yoghurt, oats and fruit |
| Pasta with plain sauce | → | Pasta with chicken or lean mince added |
| Crisps | → | Jerky, boiled eggs or cottage cheese |
| Sweet latte | → | Milk coffee or a protein coffee |

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

# A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

| | Breakfast | Lunch | Dinner |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Mon** | Eggs and toast, fruit | Chicken wrap, yoghurt | Beef mince chilli with rice |
| **Tue** | Greek yoghurt, oats, berries | Tuna and sweetcorn jacket potato | Salmon, new potatoes, greens |
| **Wed** | Omelette, spinach, toast | Turkey and rice bowl | Chicken stir-fry with noodles |
| **Thu** | Skyr, banana, granola | Cottage cheese and ham sandwich | Steak, sweet potato, salad |
| **Fri** | Protein porridge | Chicken Caesar-style salad and bread | Prawn and veg curry with rice |
| **Sat** | Scrambled eggs, smoked salmon, bagel | Lentil and chicken soup | Turkey meatballs, pasta, veg |
| **Sun** | Pancakes with cottage cheese and fruit | Leftover bowl | Roast chicken, potatoes, vegetables |

## Snacks

Cottage cheese and fruit · Boiled eggs · Milk · Jerky or biltong · Edamame · Protein shake after training

## Shopping list

Chicken, turkey, lean beef, fish, eggs · Greek yoghurt, skyr, cottage cheese, milk · Tinned tuna and salmon, lentils, beans, tofu · Oats, rice, potatoes, wholemeal bread · Frozen vegetables and berries · Whey or plant protein (optional)

GOOD TO KNOW

# Questions people ask

**Will extra protein turn into muscle?**

Only with training. Your body uses what it needs and the rest is used for energy. Beyond the range above, benefit is small.

**Do I need a shake?**

No. It is convenient after training or when busy. Real food works as well.

## Further reading

British Dietetic Association sport fact sheets; position stands from the International Society of Sports Nutrition.

### For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

# Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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